

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

- The patient's symptoms of persistent sadness , feeling hopeless , worsening suicidal ideations , and guilt are suggestive of depression .

- However , the recent onset of symptoms (over the past 2 weeks) with significant worsening could suggest a double depression .

- Mania or psychosis would present with more manic or psychotic symptoms , which are not indicated here .

- Anhedonia is common in depression , but it's not a specific symptom from the description .

- Paranoid personality disorder would not typically include significant depressive symptoms or suicidal ideation .

- The patient's long-standing depression along with recent worsening fits the criteria for double depression .

- There's no evidence of mania or psychosis , or the personality disorder .

- Anhedonia is common in depression but not specific to this scenario .

- Therefore , the best fit is double depression .

- The patient's long history of depression with recent worsening and specific symptoms of depression align with this diagnosis .

- The other options are less likely or not supported by the information given .

- The patient is at risk for double depression .

- This is the most accurate description of the patient's condition based on the given symptoms and history .

- The other options are not as accurately supported by the information provided .

- The patient's symptoms of persistent sadness , feeling hopeless , worsening suicidal ideations , and guilt over the past 2 weeks are most consistent with double depression .

- The other options are less accurate or not supported by the information provided .

- The patient's ability to hold a job and get enough sleep does not rule out depression but does not support the other options .

- The patient's symptoms are most consistent with double depression .

- The patient's symptoms are most consistent with double depression .

- The patient's symptoms are most consistent with double depression .

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<answer>A. The patient is at risk for double depression.</answer>